

CuddleNest

Your first 7 days guide

Daytime potty training, one small step at a time.

This guide comes with your CuddleNest training pants. It gives simple, general pointers. Every child learns at their own pace: there is no right date, no race, and accidents are part of the journey.

Daytime only. Training pants protect against small daytime leaks. Keep overnight protection until mornings are dry.

This guide offers general tips and does not replace advice from a health professional. If you have concerns (pain, constipation, a big step back), talk to your doctor, paediatrician or a nurse (811 health line in most provinces).

Before you start: are they ready?

Most children show several of these signs before starting. They don't need all of them.

- Their diaper stays dry for about 2 hours, or after a nap.
- They're curious about the potty or the toilet, or want to do it "like the big kids".
- They show you (words, gestures, hiding) when they pee or poop.
- They can pull pants down and up with a little help.
- They understand and follow a simple instruction: "Let's go to the potty."
- A wet or dirty diaper bothers them.

What you'll need

- Your CuddleNest pants (plan 6 to 10 pairs for a day at home, with laundry).
- A potty, or a toilet seat reducer with a small step stool.
- The printed reward chart and some stickers.
- A change bag: 2 to 3 pants, spare trousers, wipes, a bag for wet clothes.
- Time: pick a calm period, not the same month as a move, a new baby or a new daycare.

Day by day

Day 1 – Gently getting started

- Let your child pick today's pants: they're "theirs".
- Offer the potty at set times: on waking, after meals, before going out, before nap and bath.
- In between, offer about every 90 minutes. Offer, never force.
- Every try counts, even without a result: one sticker for trying.

"Want to try the potty before we play?"

Day 2 – A routine that reassures

- Keep the same times as yesterday: routine helps more than reminders.
- Make potty time pleasant: a book, a song, two or three minutes at most.
- Show the steps: pants down, sit, wipe, flush, wash hands.

"Let's sing a song while you try."

Day 3 – Accidents are part of the journey

- Day 3 is often the hardest. That's normal.
- Stay calm and neutral: no blame, no punishment.
- Get them involved: they put the wet pants in the bag and choose a clean pair.
- Training pants let them feel wet: that's how they make the connection.

"Oops, it's wet. Pee goes in the potty. Let's change together."

Day 4 – Spotting the signals

- Watch for their signals: dancing, hiding, holding, suddenly going quiet.
- Name what's happening: "I think your body is saying pee."
- Give them a simple word to say it, and praise them when they use it, even if it's too late.

"Thank you for telling me! Let's go quickly."

Day 5 – Leaving the house

- Go on a short outing: potty stop right before you leave.
- Bring the change bag and, if you can, a travel potty.
- Show them where the toilets are as soon as you arrive somewhere.

"Before we go to the park, potty stop."

Day 6 – More independence

- Let them pull their pants down and up on their own: that's why they're like real underwear.
- Offer a little less often and let them tell you when they need to go.
- Praise effort and independence more than results.

"You pulled up your pants all by yourself!"

Day 7 – Looking back

- Look at the chart together and celebrate every sticker.
- Going well? Keep the same routine. Strong resistance? A break of a few weeks is fine.
- If your child goes to daycare, share the routine with the educator (see next page).

"Look at all your stickers. I'm so proud of you."

When there's an accident

Do

- Stay calm, speak softly.
- Change them quickly, together.
- Simply remind them where pee goes.
- Thank them for every try.

Avoid

- Scold, punish or tease.
- Put a diaper back on "as a punishment".
- Compare with a sibling or a friend.
- Make them sit on the potty for a long time.

At daycare

- Tell the educator where you're at and which words your child uses.
- Send 3 to 4 spare pants and trousers, labelled with their name, plus a wet bag.
- Ask them to follow the same routine (after nap, after lunch).

Washing the pants

- Follow the care label on your pants.
- Rinse in cold water after an accident, then wash with the rest of your laundry.
- Skip fabric softener, which can reduce absorbency.

When to take a break or ask for advice

- Your child cries, holds it in or strongly refuses the potty several days in a row: take a 2 to 4 week break.
- A big change is coming (new baby, move, new daycare): setbacks are common, try again later.
- Pain, burning, constipation, or a setback that lasts: talk to a health professional.

Questions? Email us: [your email] · cuddlenest.ca
Small steps, big milestones.